

Queensland Chief Health Officer Press Statement – October 14, 2024

Issued by: Dr. [Name], Queensland Chief Health Officer (CHO)

Location: Brisbane, Queensland

"Good afternoon,

Over the past five days, we have seen an **increase in hospital admissions for acute respiratory illness** across multiple hospitals in the **Brisbane Metro North region**. As of today, we can confirm that **25 new cases** have been admitted to:

- St Andrew's War Memorial Hospital
- St Vincent's Private Hospital
- Royal Brisbane and Women's Hospital
- North West Private Hospital
- Queensland Children's Hospital

We must emphasize that these **cases appear to be separate** from the two previously recorded outbreaks at the Kelvin Grove nursing home and the Brisbane family cluster. Among these newly admitted cases, **two involve young children (ages 1 and 3), who are currently in severe condition** and receiving intensive care.

Additionally, we regret to confirm **one further fatality** among the previously hospitalized nursing home residents. This brings the total number of deaths linked to the Kelvin Grove cluster to **four**.

Testing and epidemiological investigations are ongoing. However, we want to reassure the public that **seven of the previously suspected cases have tested positive for influenza** and have been removed from the cluster investigation. This is an important reminder that seasonal viruses remain active in the community."